

Chapter 156-4

The wind had picked up outside. The bitter winter wind howled against the window frames, mixed with the sparse sounds of traffic, making the room seem exceptionally quiet.

Both Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu spoke in low voices.

They chatted in a desultory manner, just like a couple who had been together for many years.

In such a tranquil atmosphere, Xu Qingzhu slowly closed her eyes and fell asleep again.

Perhaps because her body was in too much pain.

Xu Qingzhu slept exceptionally well this time. When she woke up, she found it had snowed outside. Fine snowflakes drifted down from above, the ground a vast expanse of white, and the whole world seemed to be tinted with brightness.

But the room was already empty. She reached out to feel the other side—the spot where Liang Shi had lain was already cold.

Xu Qingzhu's mood suddenly fell.

She raised her hand to pat her own cheeks, reminding herself that this was nothing, that she shouldn't be affected by dreams.

Dreams were only so terrifying because they were just dreams.

Liang Shi wouldn't do that.

Xu Qingzhu sat on the bed in a daze. Only after a long while did she reluctantly get out of bed, then got up and pulled open all the curtains.

The pure white scenery of the world unfolded completely, like a magnificent and brilliant painting scroll.

Even with just one color of white, it was dazzling.

Xu Qingzhu unconsciously crossed her arms, rubbing them. She inexplicably felt a bit cold.

She sniffled, then went to sit on the bay window. Just as she was about to grab a plushie from the side to hold, the door creaked and a head peeked out.

Ling Dang, with her twin braids, suddenly appeared. "Auntie, you're awake!"

Xu Qingzhu was pleasantly surprised. "Ling Dang."

Ling Dang nodded: "Yes, good morning, Auntie."

Then she shouted loudly toward the kitchen: "Gugu, Auntie is awake!"

Xu Qingzhu's eyes suddenly lit up. "Your Gugu is home?"

"Yes!" Ling Dang ran in, some ends of her hair sticking up and still damp. "Gugu is making congee for you. She's such a meanie—I wanted just a sip and she wouldn't let me. She said only you can drink it."

Xu Qingzhu pulled her into her arms and stroked her hair. "When did you get here?"

"Not long ago." Ling Dang said: "My mom's friend invited her to go shopping, so I came over to play with Gugu."

"Why is your hair wet?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Ling Dang shook her braids, and they ended up hitting Xu Qingzhu's face.

Both of them froze at the same time. Ling Dang immediately reached out to rub Xu Qingzhu's face, but because she had just come in from outside, her hands were terribly cold, making Xu Qingzhu shiver.

"Sorry." Ling Dang apologized pitifully.

Xu Qingzhu smiled: "It's okay."

Then Ling Dang began talking non-stop about the interesting things at kindergarten. This included the last time it snowed, when Rainbow fell on her bottom in front of all the kindergarten kids. Her little down jacket was covered in snow, and everyone laughed at Rainbow.

Ling Dang quickly ran over to help her up, and Sheng Yu scolded everyone in front of all the kindergarten kids, saying those who laughed at Rainbow were bad kids.

And the time before that, Sheng Yu went to the bathroom but the lock was broken. It was Rainbow who noticed she was missing and went to the bathroom to rescue her.

And the time before that, Ling Dang had a fight with Shen Yiran and left her class's group during lunch, carrying her tray directly to Rainbow's class's table to eat. Sheng Yu expressed her disdain, but Rainbow spoke up for her when the teacher came to scold Ling Dang.

Also, Teacher Qi Jiao hadn't come to work in a long time.

Sheng Yu had mentioned it in front of them several times.

These were all trivial things from daily life that Ling Dang found interesting, and she shared all of them with Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu listened quietly.

Ling Dang talked until her mouth was dry. Just when she was about to run out of things to say, Liang Shi knocked on the bedroom door. "You two, get up and eat."

Ling Dang dashed out of the room to the kitchen.

Xu Qingzhu was surprised. "How come you didn't leave?"

"It's snowing today." Liang Shi said: "I don't have any scenes. They were all moved to tomorrow. I saw you were sleeping soundly, so I didn't wake you."

"Alright." Xu Qingzhu said: "I really did sleep well today."

When she woke up, it was almost 10:30.

She wasn't sure if this counted as breakfast or lunch.

But it didn't matter. She had no meetings today, so going to the company late was fine.

"I already told Lin Luoxi for you. Don't go to the company this morning." Liang Shi said: "Rest well and go in the afternoon."

Xu Qingzhu nodded in agreement.

At the dining table, only Xu Qingzhu had a bowl of congee in front of her. It was white fungus, goji berry, and lotus seed congee, smelling fragrant and sweet.

Xu Qingzhu looked at Liang Shi.

Liang Shi sat down across from her. "Didn't you say your stomach hurts? Drink this and then go lie down in bed. Rest well."

Xu Qingzhu scooped up a spoonful, blew on it gently, and drank it under Ling Dang's expectant and envious gaze.

"Did you use rock sugar?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi nodded: "Yellow rock sugar."

"We didn't have any at home." Xu Qingzhu said: "Did you go to the supermarket?"

"Mm, I stocked up all the groceries in the fridge." Liang Shi said: "You need to eat properly even when you're alone."

Xu Qingzhu: "Willing but unable."

Liang Shi: "..."

"I'll supervise you." Liang Shi said righteously.

Xu Qingzhu pouted, scooped up a spoonful, blew on it until it wasn't too hot, and fed it to Ling Dang.

Ling Dang's eyes lit up. "So sweet."

"You drink yours." Liang Shi said: "I made her a separate soup."

"I don't like seaweed soup." Ling Dang said aggrievedly. "I like sweet things."

Liang Shi flicked her forehead: "Little kids aren't allowed to be picky eaters."

Because Ling Dang was an unexpected guest at the house, there hadn't been time to make her another bowl of congee. She could only share the soup with Liang Shi.

However, this quiet home had gained a bit more warmth because of the unexpected guest's arrival.